FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of August 23–29, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — 2 John 6

"This is love, that we walk according to His commandments; this is the commandment, just as you have heard from the beginning, so that you should walk in it."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 1 Kings 3:1–15; 2 Corinthians 1:1–22
Mon: 1 Kings 5:1–18; 2 Corinthians 1:23–2:17
Tue: 1 Kings 7:51–8:21; 2 Corinthians 3:1–18
Wed: 1 Kings 8:22–30, 46–63; 2 Corinthians 4:1–18
Thu: 1 Kings 9:1–9; 10:1–13; 2 Corinthians 5:1–21
Fri: 1 Kings 11:1–26; 2 Corinthians 6:1–18
Sat: 1 Kings 11:42–12:19; 2 Corinthians 7:1–16

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Built on the Rock" — LSB 645

Built on the Rock the Church shall stand, / Even when steeples are falling; / Crumbled have spires in every land; / Bells still are chiming and calling — / Calling the young and old to rest, / But above all the soul distrest, / Longing for rest everlasting.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Thirteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 16) August 23, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 2:6–7; 117; antiphon: Psalm 115:18*

But we will bless the LORD from this time forth and forevermore.
Praise the LORD!
As for me, I have set my King
on Zion, my holy hill.
I will tell of the decree: The LORD said to me,
"You are my Son; today I have begotten you."
Praise the LORD, all nations!
Extol him, all peoples!
For great is his steadfast love toward us,
and the faithfulness of the LORD endures forever. Praise the LORD!
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
But we will bless the LORD from this time forth and forevermore.
Praise the LORD!

Collect of the Day

Almighty God, whom to know is everlasting life, grant us to know Your Son, Jesus, to be the way, the truth, and the life, that we may boldly confess Him to be the Christ and steadfastly walk in the way that leads to life eternal; through the same Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 51:1–6 · Psalm 138 · Romans 11:33–12:8 · Matthew 16:13–20

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 17)

Jeremiah 15:15–21 · Psalm 26 · Romans 12:9–21 · Matthew 16:21–28

Learn by Heart: The Office of the Keys *LSB p. 326*

"What is the Office of the Keys? It is that special authority which Christ has given to His church on earth to forgive the sins of repentant sinners, but to withhold forgiveness from the unrepentant as long as they do not repent."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: In this Sunday's Gospel, Jesus asks His disciples, "Who do you say that I am?" and Peter answers for the ages: "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God." Jesus promises to build His Church on that confession — a Rock that not even the gates of hell can overcome. Through the week, watch Solomon build a house for the LORD's name and dedicate it with a prayer that God would hear and forgive, and then watch, tragically, as his own heart wanders after other gods — God's house stands even when ours falls. Ask one another: "Who do we say Jesus is — and does our week show it?"

Kids in the Divine Service — Why Is Confession So Important?

Confessing our sins is important! When we confess them, we see just how terribly sinful we are and admit that we deserve death and separation from God. We are free to admit all of this to Him because we know that Jesus has already died and paid for all of our sins.

After Confession comes Absolution — the forgiveness of sins! "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness" (1 John 1:9). This Sunday Peter confesses, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God," and Jesus promises him and His Church the very keys that open heaven's forgiveness (Matthew 16:19).

Parents: *Before the service, read through the confession and explain any words that might be confusing. During the service, help your children follow along with the Confession and Absolution, and remind them that when the Pastor speaks the Absolution, it is as if God Himself is speaking those words of comfort to us.*

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